

Day 2 — The Magic Zero

Module: Five Gifts (Primary) · **Time:** 30 min

Goal

Children see why zero is “magic” — how it changes the value of every digit next to it.

Materials

- Whiteboard
- Drawing paper

Flow

Settle + chant (3 min)

Story (5 min)

“Long ago, people had counting systems but no number called zero. The Romans wrote one hundred like this: C. They wrote ten like this: X. There was no symbol for ‘nothing in this place.’”

“In India, mathematicians invented a special idea: ‘nothing’ is ALSO a number, and we write it as ZERO.”

“Watch what zero does:”

Activity — what zero does (15 min)

On the board: - Start with the digit **1**. - Add a zero after it: **10** (now it’s ten). - Add another zero: **100** (one hundred). - Another: **1000** (one thousand). - Another: **10,000** (ten thousand). - One more: **100,000** (one lakh). - Continue to one million.

“Without zero, we couldn’t count these big numbers easily. Zero MAKES ten and hundred and thousand possible.”

Game: Each child writes the biggest number they can think of using zero. Cheers for whoever writes the biggest!

Show + chant (5 min)

- 2 children share their big numbers.
- Daily chant.

Wrap-up (2 min)

- *“Zero is also the answer when you have NOTHING. 5 cookies — eat 5 — you have ZERO left.”*

Homework

- Find ONE thing at home that has zeros in its number (a phone, a price, an address). Bring tomorrow.

Differentiation

- **Tier up:** Count to a million in steps of 100,000.
- **Tier down:** Count zeros in 10, 100, 1000.